

Uploading Book PDFs to IngramSpark

via a Linux desktop (VNC) inside Google Cloud Shell

Full self-contained walkthrough for uploading the print files to IngramSpark from an FRP-locked phone whose normal file picker doesn't work. You run a real Linux desktop (XFCE) with Firefox inside Google Cloud Shell (free), streamed to your phone. The book files are pulled straight into that desktop from GitHub, so the phone is just a screen.

■ Cloud Shell wipes installed packages and the desktop between sessions, but files in your home folder (~) survive. If you come back later, re-run Part A steps 1–3; your saved token (Part B) still works.

Part A — Start the XFCE desktop + Firefox

1. On your phone open <https://shell.cloud.google.com>, sign in, wait for the black terminal.

2. Install the XFCE desktop and a real Firefox (paste as one block):

```
sudo apt-get update -y && sudo apt-get install -y xfce4 xfce4-goodies dbus-x11 tigervnc-standalone-server novnc
cd ~ && rm -rf firefox firefox.tar.xz
wget --content-disposition -O firefox.tar.xz "https://download.mozilla.org/?product=firefox-latest&os=linux64&
tar xf firefox.tar.xz
ls ~/firefox/firefox && echo "FIREFOX OK"
```

If Firefox won't launch later (missing libraries):

```
sudo apt-get install -y libgtk-3-0 libdbus-glib-1-2 libx11-xcb1
```

3. Start the GUI. The **exec startxfce4** line is critical — if the xstartup script exits, the VNC session tears down instantly:

```
mkdir -p ~/.vnc
printf '#!/bin/sh\nunset SESSION_MANAGER\nunset DBUS_SESSION_BUS_ADDRESS\n%s/firefox/firefox &\nexec startxfce4\n' > ~/.vnc/xstartup
chmod +x ~/.vnc/xstartup
tigervncserver -kill :1 2>/dev/null
tigervncserver :1 -geometry 1280x800 -localhost no -SecurityTypes None --I-KNOW-THIS-IS-INSECURE
pkill websockify 2>/dev/null; sleep 1
websockify --web=/usr/share/novnc 8080 localhost:5901 >/tmp/novnc.log 2>&1 &
echo "started"
```

Portrait phone screen? swap **-geometry 1280x800** for **-geometry 800x1280**.

■ XFCE gives you a full desktop: top panel, **Applications** menu, and the **Thunar** file manager to confirm ~/Downloads before uploading. **dbus-x11 is required** or XFCE half-breaks. Grey screen? wait ~15s or check **cat ~/.vnc/*.log**. Cloud Shell reinstalls XFCE each session, but ~ files (incl. ~/.vnc/xstartup and ~/.github_token) persist.

4. Open the desktop: Cloud Shell toolbar (top-right) → **Web Preview** (monitor/eye icon, maybe under ■) → **Change port** → **8080** → **Change and Preview**. If you see a directory listing or 404, add **/vnc.html** to the URL. Tap **Connect** — XFCE desktop with Firefox open.

5. Hard to navigate? noVNC tab on the **left edge** → gear → **Scaling Mode** → **Local Scaling** (fits the whole desktop). Fullscreen button is there too.

Part B — Get the book files into Cloud Shell (download from GitHub)

1. Make a GitHub token (classic)

Phone's normal browser, logged into GitHub: **Settings** → **Developer settings** → **Personal access tokens** → **Tokens (classic)** → **Generate new token (classic)** → tick the top-level **repo** box → Generate → copy it (ghp_...).

■ A valid classic token is ghp_ + 36 chars = **40 characters total**. A different length means a bad paste — the usual cause of **HTTP 401 Bad credentials**. Never paste a token into a chat/log; revoke any that lands in one.

2. (Recommended) Save the token so you never re-paste it

```
echo 'export GH_TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE' > ~/.github_token
chmod 600 ~/.github_token
```

Every future session, instead of pasting the token, run:

```
source ~/.github_token
TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN
```

3. Sanity-check the token (200 = good, 401 = bad token, 404 = no access)

```
curl -sL -o /dev/null -w "HTTP %{http_code}\n" -H "Authorization: token $TOKEN" \
  "https://api.github.com/repos/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles"
```

4. Download the files (Book One, barcode-fixed, press-ready)

```
rm -f ~/Downloads/*
cd ~/Downloads
source ~/.github_token; TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN      # or: TOKEN=PASTE_YOUR_TOKEN_HERE
api="https://api.github.com/repos/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles/contents"
get(){ curl -sL -H "Authorization: token $TOKEN" -H "Accept: application/vnd.github.raw" -o "$2" "$api/$1"; }

get "book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-PDFX1a.pdf" cover.pdf
get "book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/production/Saeren-Chronicles-Book-One-6x9-interior-r14-PDFX1a.pdf" interior.pdf

for f in cover.pdf interior.pdf; do printf "%-12s " "$f"; ls -lh "$f"|awk '{print $5}'|tr -d '\n'; printf " hd
```

■ **USE THE -PDFX1a COVER (CMYK + OutputIntent)** for upload. (If IngramSpark's ICC warning bothers you, the -CMYK-noicc cover has zero profiles and clears it; it's non-blocking either way.) **THE 112-BYTE FILE:** a ~112-byte file or header { means a bad token — run **cat ~/Downloads/cover.pdf**, fix it, re-run. A real cover shows **%PDF**, ≈ 3.9 MB.

Part C½ — Getting files IN from WhatsApp (FRP phone)

On an FRP-locked phone the native share/file-picker is dead, so you can't share a WhatsApp attachment out. Instead pull it via **WhatsApp Web inside the Cloud Shell desktop** (whose picker works), then push to GitHub. Uses WhatsApp's official Linked Devices — no third-party tools, no ToS risk.

1. In the Cloud Shell Firefox, go to **https://web.whatsapp.com** (shows a QR code).
2. On the phone: WhatsApp → ■ **menu** → **Linked devices** → **Link a device** → point the camera at the QR on the Cloud Shell screen. (FRP lock doesn't block this.) Your chats load in the desktop Firefox.
3. Open the chat → click the file → the download arrow. It saves to **~/Downloads**.
4. Push it into GitHub from the terminal:

```
source ~/.github_token; TOKEN=$GH_TOKEN
cd ~ && rm -rf SC && git clone https://x:$TOKEN@github.com/knightdx91-alt/The-Saeren-Chronicles.git SC
cd SC
```

```
git config user.email noreply@anthropic.com; git config user.name "Claude"
# copy the WhatsApp file in (change filename + destination folder):
cp ~/Downloads/THE_FILE.pdf book/genesis/saeren-chronicles/delivery/cover/
git add -A && git commit -m "add file from WhatsApp" && git push
```

■ Re-link WhatsApp Web once per Cloud Shell session (QR re-scan only; ~/.github_token persists).
Alternative to git: in the same Firefox, github.com → repo → target folder → **Add file** → **Upload files** and pick from ~/Downloads.

Part D — Upload settings on IngramSpark

In the Cloud Shell Firefox go to **ingramspark.com**, log in, open your title, start the upload. When the picker opens, choose files from **Home** → **Downloads**.

Cover: choose “**my cover already includes a barcode**” so IngramSpark does NOT overlay its own white barcode box on ours.

Interior: the 6×9 PDF/X-1a (294 pages, Book One).

ICC-profile warning if shown is **non-blocking** — proceed (or upload the -CMYK-noicc cover to clear it).

Cover size: 12.91 × 9.25 in, full-bleed, spine 0.661” (294pp cream), no white margins.

eBook is a separate format: its interior must be an **EPUB** (a PDF is rejected there).

■ If a preview shows blank, the file is usually fine (IngramSpark’s flipbook struggles with full-page CMYK).
Order a printed proof and confirm the barcode scans before approving for sale.

Quick reference — Book One files

```
cover      : delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-PDFX1a.pdf      (CMYK + OutputIntent)
            : delivery/cover/Saeren-Book-One-FULL-WRAP-r3-CMYK-noicc.pdf (zero profiles; clears ICC warning)
interior    : delivery/production/Saeren-Chronicles-Book-One-6x9-interior-r14-PDFX1a.pdf
```

Barcode verified: EAN-13 = 9798240990434 (ISBN 979-8-2409-9043-4), single barcode, no price add-on.

When done: revoke any exposed GitHub token and overwrite ~/.github_token with a fresh one.